

Council Meeting
May 15, 2024
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The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, May 15, 2023, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Girard at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present:

Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne - Absent
Ward II Councilor Brian Zutter
Ward III Councilor Jonathan Hayden
Assistant Mayor Debora Matteau – Via Phone
At-Large Councilor Joel Tremblay
At-Large Councilor Wayne Hemingway
At-Large Councilor William Limoges
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
Mayor Dale Girard

Also present:

Yoshi Manale, City Manager

AGENDA CHANGES

None.

CITIZEN’S FORUM

None.

BUDGET

Fire

Chief Chamberlain, gave an overview of the Claremont Fire Department, and presented a PowerPoint for the Council. The presentation highlighted an increase to the vehicle maintenance line, Staffing levels, Statistics, workplace culture, the probationary firefighter program, Accomplishments, and future projects which include expanding training facilities, a deputy chief of operations position for a clearer line of succession, and to continue the smoke detector program.

Mayor Girard noted the health insurance line had about a 25% increase; Manager Manale stated this was because employees were switching from a single plan to a family plan (about five). Chief Chamberlain also explained the Fire Department was down two positions last year so not all personnel was accounted for.

A motion was made by Councilor Limoges and seconded by Councilor Zutter to tentatively approve the Fire Budget for \$ 2,861,898.00.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Tremblay – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 8-0

Airport

Chief Chamberlain, gave an overview for the airport, and highlighted Stantec, the Hazard Beacon Removal project, advancing the taxiway “A” relocation project, and the increase of line items for Machine and Equipment and Lawn M&R, all remaining line items are consistent with previous years.

Councilor Koloski asked if it were possible to enter into a lease agreement for lawn care equipment. Chief Chamberlain stated the airport is looking for a regular zero turn mower.

Councilor Hayden asked if the \$18,000.00 was for 1 mower or multiple items. Chief Chamberlain replied for one mower.

Mayor Girard brought up revenue line item, and noted in the past used the rental for the six box hangars

Mayor Girard noted the maintenance of land for the easement that was just cleaned up is no different from snow removal equipment done in the past, and would like to see both line items taken out of this budget and use the money that’s being put aside for land leases.

Director Bates stated moving the revenue and noted what the City is trying to do is move all of airport into Fund 72. Fund 72 is not an enterprise fund. It's still available to use for offsetting revenue for this budget.

Mayor Girard stated he does understand what Director Bates is saying, but would still feel more comfortable to be removed and when the Chief decides to upgrade it will come back to council and approve it later on.

Councilor Koloski agrees this would be cleaner.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Limoges to tentatively approve the Fire Budget amending to remove land m&r, and machines and equipment line for \$ 106,850.00.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Tremblay – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 8-0

Planning & Development

Director Merrill gave an overview of the Planning and Development department with a power point presentation highlighting economic development, Marketing and promotion, City website, Planning, Boards and Commissions, GIS, Zoning, Building, Health and Property Maintenance Codes, Project Management, and Grant administration.

Mayor Girard noted the increase to the health insurance line.

Manager Manale noted there was one extra position excluded from the Directors presentation which is an extra position for a Deputy Director, which includes a family plan, Manager Manale explained this could also be helpful for succession planning.

Human Resource Director, Young stated there is an increase and fluctuation across most of the insurance lines, due to factors such as last years numbers not being entered correctly.

Councilor Koloski has a concern with attracting and retaining a building inspector, and noted some of our top goals is blighted properties and inspections and is really concerned about falling behind.

Manager Manale explained an amendment to the Merit System is coming to Council next week and hopes it will help to retain in these roles.

Councilor Koloski asked if those changes were reflected in this budget. Manager Manale replied, yes.

A motion was made by Councilor Hayden and seconded by Councilor Tremblay to tentatively approve the Planning and Development budget for \$ 897,332.00.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Tremblay – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 8-0

TIFD-Downtown

Director Merrill reported there is no income from the general fund, the TIFD will end in 2028. Director Merrill noted the original value was over 11 million, it is now at 32 million., and anticipates this will continue to grow. This does not mean the 32 million will come over all at once, there are still a few properties that have 79E. Director Merrill noted the TIFD committee met last week and had a discussion when TIFD ended if the program would be amended to do work in the downtown area.

Expenditures- maintenance and repair was based on what public works wanted to do in the garage and intentionally waited until now to use the funding for garage security. Director Merrill noted security was put out to bid but speaking with the police department and DPW it was decided to not do the contract security.

Manager Manale wanted to note to the Council there are improvements for security in the garage such as: lights for emergency buttons, cameras, and PD drive throughs at peak times.

Councilor Koloski asked if the Makerspace solar panels could help power the parking structure, Director Merrill will follow up.

A motion was made by Councilor Tremblay and seconded by Councilor Zutter to tentatively approve the TIFD-Downtown Budget for \$ 682,950.00.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Tremblay – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 8-0

Parks

Director Martin addressed a comment made at the last council meeting, and stated there has not been any resignations for the parks and recreation commission. Director Martin then gave a PowerPoint presentation on Parks and the CSBCC.

Mayor Girard noted the rents and leases line went up.

Director Martin explained the request for a tractor and a three-quarter pickup truck. Currently have a tractor that is over 12 years old, and a one-ton dump truck that is over 10 years old, sees the need to replace these before further problems occur.

Mayor Girard asked where we are with the 10-year plan, and wants to see it before approving this budget.

Councilor Koloski shared concern for waste removal and asked if current dumpsters could be put out to bid. Manger Manale will look into this

By consensus the City Council agrees to bring back parks budget at future meeting to see the 10-year plan.

CSB Community Center-Recreation

Manager Manale made note that Director Martin inherited these budgets, and came in during the middle of the budget process.

Councilor Zutter stated Director Martin was put into a tough situation, and is very appreciative in the director's knowledge so far.

Mayor Girard shared questions about revenue for the community center, and asked Director Bates for clarity.

Director Bates stated this came down to different approaches on bookings, Director Bates, explained Director Martin's reports were showing net revenue, on the City side the reports were showing gross revenue, Director Bates added there was another layer as the city was booking deferred revenue for the upcoming month, and what was happening was the journal entries to recognize deferred revenue as regular revenue weren't being made, throwing off all the revenue numbers.

Director Bates noted working with Director Martin to come up with a plan for the upcoming fiscal year by shifting and reporting numbers the same way.

Mayor Girard questioned the line item for Canva, Zoom, and BMI Music rights
Manager Manale explained Canva is a design tool anyone can use to create presentations, flyers, and things like that for social media. Zoom we all use, and BMI is for Music.

Director Martin mentioned this was put in the budget from the previous director, and noted BMI is music rights at events, or playing over the loudspeakers in the community center.

Manager Manale suggested to reduce this line by \$10,000.00, along with the \$10,000.00 of the information and technology line for a total of \$20,000.00.

A motion was made by Councilor Tremblay and seconded by Councilor Limoges to tentatively approve the CSB Community Center Budget for \$1,408,027.00.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Tremblay – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 8-0

Finance City Administration

Director Bates explained the consulting and training line has increased, and there is a vacancy in treasury role.

A motion was made by Councilor Hayden and seconded by Councilor Tremblay to tentatively approve the Finance Budget for \$ 973,024.00.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Tremblay – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 8-0

General Services

A motion was made by Councilor Limoges and seconded by Councilor Hayden to tentatively approve the General Services Budget for \$1,042,011.00.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Tremblay – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 8-0

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None.

ADJOURNMENT

At 8:56 p.m., a motion was made by Councilor Zutter and seconded by Councilor Tremblay to adjourn.

Roll Call:

Koloski – yes

Tremblay – yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Zutter – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 8-0

Respectfully Submitted,

Julia A. Bizzarro
Clerk to the Council